两次卖掉埃菲尔铁塔的骗子

The Man Who Sold the Eiffel Tower Twice



铁塔怎么成了骗子的“货物”？

英文原文

In 1925 six scrap-metal traders met secretly at the Hôtel de Crillon in Paris. A deputy director-general of the Ministry of Posts and Telegraphs shared the momentous news, confidentially, that the Eiffel Tower was to be sold for scrap. He invited tenders and made each dealer solemnly vow secrecy, ostensibly to spare the public indignation.

The pretext was not absurd. Built for the 1889 World's Fair, the monument had originally been destined to come down after twenty years. The high-ranking deputy was Victor Lustig, a crook whose ministerial stationery was a forgery. He had read a newspaper article in which the authorities lamented the hefty cost of the tower's upkeep.

André Poisson, a businessman impatient to gain a foothold in Paris, won. Lustig intimated that his modest civil-service remuneration needed supplementing, and Poisson paid an additional bribe. Lustig left for Vienna with the takings.

Fleeced and too ashamed to go to the police, Poisson swallowed the loss quietly. Not a whisper of the deceit appeared in print.

About a month later Lustig had the gall to reappear with an encore of his script for new dealers. This time the winner grew distrustful and went to the police. The affair made the papers, and Lustig made his getaway. The much-repeated second sale is a fairy tale.

Later arrested in the United States for making fake money, Lustig broke out of detention, was recaptured 27 days later and served time on the penal island of Alcatraz. He died of pneumonia in 1947.

Of Lustig's two marks, the one who paid kept mum and the one who kept his money went to the police.

中文译文

1925年，六名废金属商人在巴黎克里雍酒店秘密会面。邮电部的一名副总负责人私下告诉他们一则重大消息：埃菲尔铁塔将当作废铁出售。他邀请商人投标，并要求每个人郑重发誓保密，表面上的理由是避免引起公愤。

这个借口并不荒唐。铁塔为1889年世博会而建，原本计划二十年后拆除。那位位高权重的“副总负责人”其实是骗子维克多·卢斯蒂格，带有政府部门抬头的信笺也是伪造的。他曾在报上看到，当局抱怨铁塔维护费用高昂。

急于在巴黎站稳脚跟的商人安德烈·普瓦松中标。卢斯蒂格暗示，自己微薄的公务员薪酬需要补贴，普瓦松便又付了一笔贿赂。随后，卢斯蒂格带着到手的钱前往维也纳。

普瓦松被骗了钱，却因羞于报警而默默咽下损失。报纸上连关于这场骗局的一点风声都没有。

大约一个月后，卢斯蒂格竟又厚着脸皮回来，向新一批商人重演旧把戏。这一次，中标者起了疑心，前去报警。事情登上报纸，卢斯蒂格逃之夭夭。广为流传的“第二次卖成铁塔”，其实只是虚构故事。

后来，卢斯蒂格在美国因制造假币被捕。他从拘留处逃出，27天后再次落网，并在恶魔岛监狱服刑。1947年，他死于肺炎。

卢斯蒂格的两个行骗对象中，付了钱的那人守口如瓶，保住钱的那人反而报了警。

标题里的“两次卖掉”是传说；原文明确，第二次骗局没有得手。

核心词汇

先记这22项。连着下方的原文短语一起回想。

scrap-metal adj.
废金属的
six scrap-metal traders

confidentially adv.
私下地；保密地
confidentially

tender n.
投标
He invited tenders

vow v.
发誓；郑重保证
solemnly vow secrecy

ostensibly adv.
表面上；声称地
ostensibly to spare

public indignation 名词短语
公愤；公众愤怒
the public indignation

pretext n.
借口；托词
The pretext was not absurd

destined adj.
原定的；注定的
destined to come down

crook n.
骗子；不法之徒
a crook

stationery n.
信笺；办公文具
ministerial stationery

forgery n.
伪造品；伪造文件
was a forgery

upkeep n.
维护；保养
the tower's upkeep

gain a foothold 动词短语
站稳脚跟；取得一席之地
gain a foothold in Paris

intimate v.
暗示
Lustig intimated

remuneration n.
报酬；薪酬
civil-service remuneration

bribe n.
贿赂；贿款
an additional bribe

fleece v.
骗取钱财；敲竹杠
Fleeced and too ashamed

deceit n.
欺骗；骗局
a whisper of the deceit

have the gall to 动词短语
竟敢厚着脸皮做……
had the gall to reappear

grow distrustful 动词短语
起疑；变得不信任
the winner grew distrustful

detention n.
拘留；羁押
broke out of detention

keep mum 动词短语
守口如瓶；保持沉默
the one who paid kept mum

文中词汇与搭配

补充词汇共35项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

trader n.
商人；交易者

secretly adv.
秘密地

deputy adj.
副职的

director-general n.
总负责人；总局长

momentous adj.
重大的；影响深远的

solemnly adv.
郑重地；严肃地

secrecy n.
保密；秘密状态

absurd adj.
荒唐的

monument n.
纪念建筑；纪念物

originally adv.
原本；最初

come down 动词短语
被拆除；倒下

high-ranking adj.
高级别的；位高权重的

ministerial adj.
政府部门的；部级机关的

lament v.
哀叹；抱怨

hefty cost 名词短语
高昂费用

businessman n.
商人

impatient adj.
急切的；迫不及待的

civil-service adj.
公务员的；文官的

文中词汇与搭配 续

补充词汇共35项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

supplement v.
补充；补贴

additional adj.
额外的

takings n.
到手的钱；收入

ashamed adj.
羞愧的；感到丢人的

quietly adv.
默默地；不声张地

whisper n.
一点风声；耳语

reappear v.
再次出现

encore n.
重演；再来一遍

script n.
台词；既定说辞

affair n.
事件；事情

getaway n.
逃脱；逃走

much-repeated adj.
被反复讲述的

fairy tale 名词短语
童话；虚构故事

fake adj.
假的；伪造的

recapture v.
再次抓获

serve time 动词短语
服刑

penal adj.
刑罚的；监禁的

回想与回顾

先遮住下方答案，再把四个词放回原文。

01 The _____ was not absurd.

02 The high-ranking deputy was Victor Lustig, a crook whose ministerial stationery was a _____.

03 Lustig intimated that his modest civil-service _____ needed supplementing, and Poisson paid an additional bribe.

04 Of Lustig's two marks, the one who paid _____ and the one who kept his money went to the police.

文章主线

- 冒充 1925年，卢斯蒂格伪造公文、冒充邮电部官员，邀六名废金属商秘密投标，谎称埃菲尔铁塔要卖废铁。
- 借口 铁塔原拟在世博会20年后拆除，维护费又高；卢斯蒂格利用这些真背景，并以免引公愤为由要求保密。
- 得手 急于在巴黎立足的普瓦松付了购塔款和贿赂，受骗后却羞于报警，让卢斯蒂格带钱逃走。
- 再骗 约一月后，卢斯蒂格重演骗局，新买家起疑报警且未付款；所谓第二次卖成铁塔的故事并不成立。
- 下场 卢斯蒂格后来在美国因造假币被捕，越狱27天后再落网，在恶魔岛监狱服刑，1947年死于肺炎。

参考答案　1 pretext 2 forgery 3 remuneration 4 kept mum